Tomáš Haufer

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Education

CERGE-EI, Charles University & Czech Academy of Sciences — Prague, Czech Republic
Master in Economic Research (MA) — Sep. 2025 – Jun. 2027 (expected)

- Grade average **1.00/1.00** (all A), 66 ECTS — first year of the programme.

Prague University of Economics and Business (VŠE) — Prague, Czech Republic
Bachelor's Degree in Economics — Sep. 2022 – Jun. 2025

- Graduated in the **top 10%** of the cohort.
- Thesis: *The Laffer Curve in the Czech Republic*; supervisor: Pavel Potužák; nominated by the examination committee for the Faculty of Economics Dean's Award for an outstanding thesis.

University of Agder (UiA) — Kristiansand, Norway
Erasmus+ Exchange Programme — Jan. 2024 – May 2024

- 27.5 ECTS: Business Analytics, Public Administration and Management, Norwegian.

Additional training: BREAD–IGC virtual PhD-level course in Political Economy, Sep.–Nov. 2026; Prague–Glasgow Summer School in Economics (VŠE and University of Glasgow), 2024.

Research Interests

Economic History · Institutional and Political Economy · Applied Economics

Research Experience

Research Assistant to Clara Sievert (full-time Jun.–Sep., part-time Oct.–Dec.) — CERGE-EI, Prague
Religion and development: data analysis of a field RCT in the DRC — Jun. 2026 – Dec. 2026

- Built a Stata and Python pipeline that merges four types of original surveys, constructs outcome indices and runs the treatment-effect regressions, with results shown in interactive dashboards of my own design.
- Presented results to Clara Sievert and her co-authors Nathan Nunn, Jonathan Weigel and Marina Ngoma; developed the analysis and output code with AI coding agents (Claude Code), verified by automated checks.
- Early-stage projects on Dutch and Czech economic history with Clara Sievert and Felipe Valencia Caicedo, drawing on large-scale digitised historical records and assessing the feasibility of new data sources.

Moody's Analytics — Prague, Czech Republic
Economic Analysis Summer Intern — Jun. 2025 – Aug. 2025

- Updated the Moody's Précis® Report for Romania, analysing the country's key macroeconomic indicators.
- Assisted with writing EViews scripts for data work on the Economic Scenarios for Climate Risk project and performed quality checks on forecast time series.
- Authored two published Economic View commentaries (CEE outlook; UAE oil shock) and contributed to work on exchange-rate equations in the Global Macroeconomic Model.

Research in Progress

The Fateful Adventures of the Good Soldiers — MA thesis + paper
Loyalty, Desertion, and the Czechoslovak Legions (supervisor: Sebastian Ottinger) — Feb. 2026 – present

- Asks how soldiers' nationalist and political views shaped two desertion decisions by the same men: from the Habsburg army into the Czechoslovak Legions, and later from the Legions themselves — a volunteer force, so staying reflects commitment, not fear of punishment.
- Assembles ~300,000 individual soldier records from two archival datasets (~133,000 of them legionnaires), not previously used in economic research.

- Digitises the 1910 census gazetteer (*Lexikon obcí*) of Bohemia, Moravia, and Silesia — the only source reaching settlement level — and the member lists of the Matice česká and Matice moravská. With Czech amateur theatre and local institutions (schools, cooperatives), these measure nationalism in soldiers' home areas.

Written in Time Term Project, CERGE-EI

Emotional and stylistic structure in the Project Gutenberg corpus Feb. 2026 – May 2026

- Built a dataset of 59,969 English-language books × 79 features (emotion scores, stylometric measures, semantic fields) from Project Gutenberg metadata and full texts.
- Residualised the features on decade, country, and genre fixed effects, then applied clustering and network analysis; language shifts towards fear and conflict after 1914.

What Drives Referee Performance? Term Project, CERGE-EI

The effect of referee coaches on referee performance Oct. 2025 – Jan. 2026

- Built an original panel dataset on referee performance, education, and career progression in Czech floorball (two regions, 2023/24–2024/25) by scraping and matching sources; estimated the effect of coaches' observations with multiple fixed effects and clustered standard errors in Python.

Policy Commentary and Writing

Central and Eastern Europe Outlook: United in Diversity, Moody's Analytics Aug. 2025

Shifting Sands: The UAE Under an Oil Shock (with Thomas Sgouralis), Moody's Analytics Aug. 2025

Diary of an Econ Student — econdiary.substack.com, a data-driven economics blog Sep. 2025 – present

Skills

Programming: Python, R, Stata, EViews, LaTeX; LLM-assisted data extraction and coding pipelines.

Empirical methods: Panel data and fixed effects; archival record linkage and census digitisation; web scraping and dataset construction; unsupervised learning; time series; IV/2SLS and GMM.

Languages: Czech (native), English (C1, Cambridge FCE Grade A), German (A2–B1), Norwegian (A1).

Test scores: TOEFL iBT 5.5/6 (Reading 6.0, Listening 6.0, Speaking 5.5, Writing 5.0), Sep. 2026; GRE Quantitative 164, Verbal 155, Analytical Writing 4.0, Oct. 2026.

Teaching and Service

Czech Floorball — Referee Coach and Member of the Regional Committee May 2023 – May 2027

Hradec Králové and Pardubice region. Teach at referee certification seminars and train new referee coaches; mentor referees and compile the statistics used for nominations. Voted the region's best referee coach (2023/24; third in 2022/23).

FBC Trutnov (DTJ) — Secretary / Manager Apr. 2023 – May 2027

Run a medium-sized sports club: budgeting, competition entries, logistics, partnerships, marketing.

Other Professional Experience

Siemens, s.r.o. — Trainee, Social Media and Communications, Trutnov Aug. 2023 – Feb. 2025

Investown Technologies, s.r.o. — Finance Analyst Intern, Prague Feb. 2023 – Jun. 2023

References

Sebastian Ottinger
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Clara Sievert
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Dawn Holland
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